KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The conflict in Iran is not Europe's war, but is hurting it through an energy crisis that can slow down economies
- The US' goals are unclear and, though they talk with all sides, Europe has no role in shaping the conflict
- Unlike in the past, no person from the younger generation wants to go to war. The need is for a rules-based order



ANTONIO BARTOLI ▲

Ambassador of Italy to India

> **We should always leverage the right signals—this is a wake-up call for Europe for strategic autonomy**
>
> **Several things have undermined the UN's credibility. We wish the UN would be a more effective body**

> **The Spanish government's position is very clear: no to war, yes to peace. Disruptions cause huge trouble for everyone involved**
>
> **India should be the locomotive of the world in favour of harmony and inclusiveness. We have to move from United Nations to united humanity**



JUAN ANTONIO MARCH PUJOL ▲

Ambassador of Spain to India

actors, including Iran. As Ackermann put it, "I see European influence in this scenario in the Middle East not as huge. There is no big way in which we can influence this war right now." However, he said that European nations talk to all countries in West Asia and that "we also talk to Americans to find out where the war is going".

Asked about India's role in a conflict that threatens to disrupt global business, Ackermann pointed out how European countries and India share a similar position—poised to suffer immensely from the energy supply disruptions, yet maintaining good ties with US, Israel, Iran and Gulf nations. India was well-positioned to ask and reason with the US for more clarity, he felt. As Pujol put it, "India should be the locomotive of the world in favour of harmony and inclusiveness." ■